

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

Bitter Food, Better Health?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 10

NO MORE THAN THREE WORDS - Bitter food: possible effects and public perception

No.	Sentence
1	It can interact with the gut _____.
2	It may help control _____.
3	It may even counter long-lasting _____ in the body.
4	People's actual _____ to bitter food may be greater than they realise.
5	Yet bitter food carries _____ in people's minds, both as a flavour and an emotion.
6	Among the drinks named, the chef says every kind of _____ has a bitter element.

11 **What is the main point of the research described in the discussion?**

- A Bitter foods mainly improve people's sense of taste.
- B Bitter foods have been shown to cure digestive illness.
- C Bitter foods may influence several aspects of health.
- D Bitter foods produce the same effect in every person.

12 **What tension does the discussion identify about bitter foods?**

- A They may be beneficial, yet people can find them hard to enjoy.
- B Their health effects are clear, but their flavour has not been studied.
- C They are popular with chefs, yet unavailable to most consumers.
- D They may taste pleasant, yet people avoid them for health reasons.

13 **According to the chef, how do people's beliefs about bitter foods compare with their experience?**

- A They dislike bitterness because they have rarely encountered it.
- B They expect bitterness mainly in unfamiliar specialty foods.
- C They notice it in food but rarely associate it with emotions.
- D They may encounter it often while still thinking of it negatively.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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14 **Why does the chef name chocolate, coffee and alcohol?**

- A To suggest that bitter ingredients should be added to everyday diets.
- B To illustrate that familiar products can have a bitter element.
- C To show that people's bitter preferences change with age.
- D To distinguish foods with bitterness from drinks without bitterness.